

markpublish.yaml

Top level of the configuration file: `document`, `theme`, `parts`, optional `templates_dir`. All paths are relative to the directory containing this file. Build using: `markpublish build [CONFIG_FILE] [OPTIONS]`.

document

Metadata and global layout toggles. Only `title` is required.

Key	Default	Description
<code>title</code>	<i>Required</i>	Document title (cover page, header, filename)
<code>subtitle</code>	–	Subtitle on the cover page
<code>summary</code>	–	Summary / abstract on the cover page
<code>author</code>	–	Author name (cover page)
<code>date</code>	<code>auto</code>	Date on the cover page (<code>auto</code> or <code>today</code> for build date)
<code>version</code>	–	Version number on the cover page and in the footer
<code>status</code>	–	Document status on the cover page (e.g. <code>Draft</code> , <code>Approved</code>)
<code>copyright</code>	–	Copyright notice on the cover page
<code>language</code>	System locale	ISO language code for static labels (<code>de</code> , <code>en</code>)
<code>cover</code>	<code>false</code>	Generate cover page (<code>true</code> or <code>false</code>)
<code>header</code>	<code>true</code>	Enable running headers (<code>true</code> or <code>false</code>)
<code>footer</code>	<code>true</code>	Enable footers (<code>true</code> or <code>false</code>)
<code>document_toc</code>	<code>full</code>	Main table of contents: <code>none</code> , <code>full</code> , or depth as integer
<code>part_toc</code>	<code>full</code>	Default for part divider pages: <code>none</code> , <code>full</code> , or depth
<code>chapter_toc</code>	<code>full</code>	Default for chapter divider pages: <code>none</code> , <code>full</code> , or depth
<code>autonum_style</code>	<code>decimal</code>	Heading numbering style: <code>decimal</code> , <code>roman</code> , <code>legal</code> , <code>none</code>
<code>autonum_from_level</code>	<code>1</code>	Starting heading level to number (1 = H1, 2 = H2, ...)
<code>autonum_prefix</code>	–	Prefix for heading numbers (e.g. <code>A.</code> for <code>A.1</code>)
<code>autonum_reset</code>	<code>false</code>	Reset heading numbering counter for each chapter
<code>pagenum_reset</code>	<code>false</code>	Reset page numbering for each part or chapter

Custom metadata fields under `document:` (e.g. `department: "R&D"`, `project: "Alpha"`) are forwarded to the theme via the `meta` dictionary (`meta.at("field").value`) and rendered if supported by the theme. Static labels belong in `i18n.yaml`, not in `document:`.

parts and chapters

Exactly two hierarchy levels: `parts:` structures sections, `chapters:` holds the content. Page titles are derived from the markdown file's H1; table of contents and divider titles can be configured individually.

Key	Level	Default	Description
<code>part</code>	Part	<i>Required</i>	Name of the section
<code>chapters</code>	Part	<i>Required</i>	List of chapters in this section
<code>file</code>	Chapter	<i>Required</i>	Path to markdown file (relative to config)
<code>show_title</code>	Chapter	<code>true</code>	Show file H1 on content page (<code>false</code> hides it)
<code>toc_title</code>	Part / Chapter	File H1 / <code>part</code>	Title for main table of contents and headers
<code>divider_title</code>	Part / Chapter	<code>part</code> / File H1	Title on the divider page
<code>subtitle</code>	Part / Chapter	–	Subtitle on the divider page
<code>summary</code>	Part / Chapter	–	Short description on the divider page
<code>break_before</code>	Part / Chapter	<code>none</code> / <code>page</code>	Page break: <code>divider</code> (divider page), <code>page</code> , OR <code>none</code>
<code>document_toc</code>	Part / Chapter	inherited	Contribution to main TOC (<code>none</code> , <code>full</code> , <code>depth</code>)
<code>part_toc</code>	Part	inherited	Local TOC on part divider page
<code>chapter_toc</code>	Part / Chapter	inherited	Local TOC on chapter divider page
<code>autonum_style</code>	Part / Chapter	inherited	Local numbering style (<code>decimal</code> , <code>roman</code> , <code>legal</code> , <code>none</code>)
<code>autonum_from_level</code>	Part / Chapter	inherited	Level at which numbering begins
<code>autonum_prefix</code>	Part / Chapter	inherited	Prefix for numbers in this section
<code>autonum_reset</code>	Part / Chapter	inherited	Reset numbering counter at start of section/chapter
<code>pagenum_reset</code>	Part / Chapter	inherited	Reset page numbering at start

`document_toc: 1` lists a chapter without its subheadings; set at the part level, it flattens all contained chapters at once. Options marked *inherited* inherit their default value from `document` through the part to the chapter – the more specific setting wins.

Templates and Themes

Everything visible is controlled by a theme: typography, page layout, and static text. The built-in default theme `default` is provided for PDF.

Where Themes Are Located

The first match wins — a theme is always loaded from exactly one source location and never merged across multiple locations. Which theme is used is determined by the `--theme` command-line option or the `theme:` setting in `markpublish.yaml` (default: `default`).

Rank	Location
1. User	<code>~/.markpublish/templates/<theme>/</code> or user-specific AppData directory
2. Project	<code>--templates-dir</code> on CLI, <code>templates_dir:</code> in YAML, <code>MARKPUBLISH_TEMPLATES_DIR</code> , or <code>./templates/<theme>/</code>
3. Package	Built-in standard theme <code>default</code>

`markpublish templates` lists all templates available on the system along with their resolution rank and origin.

Customizing a Theme

```
markpublish export-template default ./templates
```

This command copies the built-in theme files into your project directory, where resolution rank 2 automatically discovers and uses them on the next build. For PDF output, a theme directory contains:

- `template.typ`: Main Typst layout template defining page geometry, headers, footers, and styles
- `i18n.yaml`: Shared label definitions and localized strings across the theme
- `pdf/i18n.yaml`: Format-specific label definitions and string overrides for PDF
- `fonts/`: Optional custom font files (`.ttf`, `.otf`) loaded by Typst
- `assets/`: Image assets, logos, and vector icons

Static Labels (i18n)

Labels resolve through a four-stage cascade; a lower level overrides only the keys it explicitly defines:

Level	File
1. Application	markpublish/i18n.yaml (application default strings)
2. Theme	<templates>/<theme>/i18n.yaml
3. Target format	<templates>/<theme>/pdf/i18n.yaml
4. Project	./i18n.yaml next to markpublish.yaml

Each file is organized by language code (de:, en:); the key "*" applies to all languages. Level 4 belongs to the project: it allows overriding labels and localizing custom metadata fields (department: "Department"). Use markpublish labels --overridden OR markpublish labels --theme <theme> to inspect the cascade before building.

Key CLI Commands

Command	Key Options	Description
markpublish build	--theme, --target, -o, -- templates-dir	Compile document to PDF
markpublish init	[TARGET], --title, --lang	Set up a minimal starter project
markpublish cheatsheet	--lang, --theme, -o, -- templates-dir	Generate this quick reference as PDF
markpublish manual	--lang, --theme, -o, -- templates-dir	Generate the complete user manual
markpublish templates	--target, --templates-dir	List templates and lookup rank
markpublish export-template	[THEME], [TARGET], --target	Export template files for customization
markpublish labels	--theme, --target, -- templates-dir, --overridden	Inspect static labels and metadata